

Anuhith Gosala crowned after *Royal Clash*

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Last year, Ved “Beelzeboy” Bamb made history by becoming the first Indian to win the Pokémon Go World Championships. It forced the esports circuit to take note of India’s rising prominence.

Another such occasion came up this year, as Anuhith Gosala won gold in Clash Royale at the Global Esports Games Mumbai — the grand final of the 2025 edition of the Games, which took place between March 19 and 23.

Not just that, India won bronze in DOTA 2, ensuring podium finishes in both titles of the tournament.

The Global Esports Games is the flagship event of Global Esports Federation (GEF) — a Singapore-based non-governmental organisation — that has been organising the tournament since 2021.

The finals of the 2025 edition took place in Mumbai, with 48 elite players from 19 countries competing for the crown in two titles. It was slightly different from the last two editions, which had DOTA 2, eFootball, Street Fighter and PUBG Mobile as their titles.

The 2025 finals in Mumbai featured DOTA 2 and Clash Royale.

In Clash Royale, India fell 0-2 to Kazakhstan in the upper bracket. However, a 2-1 win over the USA in the lower-bracket decider gave Gosala a shot at redemption. And he did not disappoint, beating Miras of Kazakhstan 3-2 and then lifting the trophy with the tricolour around his shoulders.

“This is for India, and for everyone who believes in us.

I hope this win inspires many others to follow in our path,” he said after the triumph.

Meanwhile, in DOTA 2, India won the bronze medal after losing to Mongolia in the lower bracket finals. In the grand finals, Turkiye defeated Mongolia 3-1 to claim the gold medal.

The next edition of the Games will take place in Los Angeles from December 2 to 10.

SKYESPORTS, GODLIKE ESPORTS SIGN MOU WITH MAHARASHTRA CYBER

“When I was 10 years old, my parents didn’t (always) encourage me to play cricket. Now, my wife takes my kids to the CSK (Chennai Super Kings Academy). We see a similar future for esports in India,” Shiva Nandy, the founder and CEO of Skyesports, had told Sportstar.

He was then busy organising the Chennai Esports Global Championship (CEGC) in November last year – a step to nurture the esports ecosystem in Tamil Nadu. His next step seems to be further west in Maharashtra.

In March 2026, Skyesports and GodLike Esports – an esports organisation — teamed up with Maharashtra Cyber to work on another aspect of esports: cyber hygiene.

The agreement was formalised during a closed-door meeting in Mumbai.

The MoU primarily has three aspects: Skyesports will organise and promote tournaments for cyber hygiene messaging, GodLike Esports will contribute through professional player mentorship, while Maharashtra Cyber will support safety campaigns, promoting responsible online practices within the ecosystem.

